



The Standard interface

Orkut, and others. Doing this allows you to roam the Googlescape with a single ID. Below the mail folders, you will see the integrated chat box, where you can engage in instant messaging with other Gmail users. And further below comes the personal Labels box, where you can access labelled e-mails.

10.2.3 Understanding Conversations and Labels

Google refers to e-mails as units of a conversation. A conversation can drag across many e-mails going in both directions. With Gmail, all these e-mails are accessible under a single link in the inbox. Contrast this with other e-mail services where only a "Replied" icon is available to indicate that an e-mail has been replied to. To read the reply, one needs to access the Sent Folder. In Gmails, as long as the receiver and sender are the same, all the e-mails are considered as part of a conversation and are available from the Inbox.

Labels are Google's way of classifying e-mails. An e-mail can have more than one label. Unlike mailbox folders as found in other e-mail providers, in Gmail, Inbox, Sent, Trash, etc. are all pre-defined labels. All incoming e-mails are automatically labelled Inbox by Gmail, and all Sent e-mails are also correspondingly labelled.



Chat box and labels